Buddhi Align App

> Buddhi Yoga as a practical system for clarity, self-regulation, and purposeful daily action.

This project is dedicated by **Aarti S Ravikumar** to **Shishubharati**.

The author is deeply grateful to the teachers and volunteers of Shishu Bharati for their guidance, service, and living example of values-centered education.

Website: https://www.shishubharati.net/

Abstract

Buddhi Align App is a contemplative technology platform that operationalizes Buddhi Yoga principles into measurable, daily practice. The project combines philosophical depth with modern engineering rigor: modular architecture, testable boundaries, clear quality gates, and reproducible development workflows. Its objective is to support inner clarity through structured action, reflective observation, and habit-aware guidance.

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Project Overview

Buddhi Align App is a maintainable monorepo that translates Buddhi Yoga principles into practical digital tools. It helps users align intellect, emotion, and action through structured reflection and habit-aware practice.

The app is organized into focused modules (karma, bhakti, jnana, dhyana, vasana, dharma), with an optional backend API for CRUD operations and a reusable UI package for consistency across screens.

Problem Statement and Scope

Problem

Most productivity and self-improvement tools optimize output volume, not psychological alignment. Users often gain activity while losing clarity.

Scope

Buddhi Align focuses on:

- Reflection quality over task quantity.
- Intention tracking over superficial streak metrics.
- Module-level extensibility without architectural coupling.

Out of Scope (Current)

- Multi-user identity and cloud sync.
- Long-term persistent backend storage.
- Clinical or therapeutic claim frameworks.

Vision and Design Principles

- **Clarity first:** UI and workflows emphasize reflection and intentionality over distraction.
- **Modularity:** New modules can be added without destabilizing existing features.
- **Accessibility and inclusivity:** Components are built to be readable and operable across devices.
- **Privacy-first defaults:** No analytics tracking is enabled by default.
- **Maintainability:** Workspace scripts, test hooks, and package boundaries are explicit and reproducible.

Theoretical Foundation

The project is inspired by the Bhagavad Gita and Vedantic interpretation of human psychology.

- **Buddhi**: discriminative intelligence that guides meaningful action.

- **Manas**: reactive mind shaped by sensory impressions and emotional patterns.
- **Vasanas**: latent tendencies that drive repeated behavior.

The operating premise is practical: when action is intentional, selfless, and observed with awareness, reactive conditioning decreases and psychological clarity increases.

Four Practice Lenses Implemented in the App

1. **Karma Yoga:** Action without fixation on outcomes.
2. **Bhakti:** Devotional orientation and gratitude.
3. **Jnana:** Inquiry, self-observation, and identity clarity.
4. **Dhyana:** Focused attention and contemplative stillness.

Feature Modules

- **Buddhi Dashboard:** Central launcher and progress context.
- **Karma Yoga Tracker:** Track service-oriented action.
- **Bhakti Journal:** Record gratitude and devotional reflections.
- **Jnana Reflection:** Capture insight and contemplative thought.
- **Dhyana Meditation:** Support guided and self-led practice.
- **Vasana Tracker:** Observe habit loops and triggers.
- **Dharma Planner:** Align action items with role and purpose.
- **Motivation and Analytics:** Present progress patterns and encouragement.

Architecture

The repository is a workspace monorepo with independently versioned app and package units.

```
apps/
   frontend/           Next.js app (App Router, TypeScript)
   backend/            Express API with in-memory stores
packages/
   shared-ui/          Shared React UI components used by frontend
   site-config/        Shared site/theme/config surface
```

Runtime Model

- Frontend runs independently as a static-capable Next.js web app.
- Backend is optional for local API-backed workflows.
- Shared packages are consumed through workspace links.

Architectural Rationale

- **Monorepo:** ensures consistent dependency and quality policy across all modules.
- **Shared UI package:** enforces visual and behavioral consistency.
- **Optional backend:** allows both offline-style and API-backed development workflows.
- **Explicit scripts:** makes CI parity straightforward for local contributors.

Repository Structure

Key top-level files:

- `package.json`: workspace orchestration scripts.
- `package-lock.json`: reproducible dependency graph.
- `buddhi-align-app.code-workspace`: VS Code workspace definition.

Key app files:

- `apps/frontend/app/page.tsx`: dashboard entry page.
- `apps/backend/index.js`: API bootstrap and route definitions.
- `apps/backend/index.test.js`: backend API test coverage.

Technology Stack

- **Frontend:** Next.js 14, React 18, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS.
- **Backend:** Node.js, Express 5, CORS middleware.
- **Testing:** Vitest + Testing Library (frontend), Node test runner + Supertest (backend).
- **Monorepo orchestration:** npm workspaces + `npm-run-all`.

Quick Start

Prerequisites

- Node.js 18+ recommended.
- npm 9+ recommended.

Install

```
npm install
```

Run development environment

```
npm run dev
```

This starts frontend and backend in parallel.

Open application

- Frontend: `http://localhost:3000`
- Backend (optional): `http://localhost:4000`

Scripts and Development Workflows

Run from repository root:

- `npm run dev`: start frontend and backend together.
- `npm run dev:frontend`: start Next.js frontend only.
- `npm run dev:backend`: start Express backend only.
- `npm run lint`: run frontend lint checks.
- `npm test`: run frontend and backend tests.
- `npm run build`: build frontend and run backend build step.

Recommended local quality loop

```
npm run lint && npm test && npm run build
```

Backend API Contract

Base URL: `http://localhost:4000`

Health/banner

- `GET /` -> plain text: `Buddhi Align App Backend API`

Module resources

Supported modules:

- `karma`
- `bhakti`
- `jnana`
- `dhyana`
- `vasana`
- `dharma`

For each module `<mod>`:

- `GET /api/<mod>`: list entries.
- `POST /api/<mod>`: create entry; server assigns `id`.
- `PUT /api/<mod>/:id`: update existing entry.
- `DELETE /api/<mod>/:id`: delete entry.

Data behavior notes

- Storage is in-memory only and resets on server restart.
- `PUT` and `DELETE` return `404` when ID is not found.

Data Lifecycle and Privacy Model

Data classes

- **Reflection entries:** user-provided text records across module workflows.
- **Derived context:** UI-level summaries and display transformations.

Storage model

- Default backend storage is volatile in-memory state for local development.
- Restarting backend clears runtime data by design.

Privacy posture

- No tracking analytics are enabled by default.
- No automatic third-party export pipeline is included.
- Users retain control over where and how deployment data is hosted.

Testing and Quality Gates

- Frontend tests are under `apps/frontend/app/**/*.test.tsx`.
- Backend tests are under `apps/backend/*.test.js`.

Current CI-equivalent local checks:

1. Linting passes (`next lint`).
2. Frontend tests pass (`vitest run`).
3. Backend API tests pass (`node --test`).
4. Production build succeeds (`next build`).

Security Notes

- Dependency scanning should be run periodically with:

```
npm audit --omit=dev
```

- Some advisories may require major-version upgrades. Handle these through controlled migrations with regression checks.

Operational Excellence Checklist

- Clear build, lint, and test gates exist and are script-addressable.
- Frontend and backend have independent test execution paths.
- Module boundaries are explicit through workspace package topology.
- Documentation includes architecture, API contract, and development lifecycle.
- Reproducibility is enforced by lockfile and workspace scripts.

Roadmap and Future Research

1. Add persistent storage adapters with explicit migration boundaries.
2. Expand frontend test coverage to route-level and component integration depth.
3. Introduce observability hooks for non-invasive quality diagnostics.
4. Add export/import flows for user-owned reflection archives.
5. Explore longitudinal insight models grounded in ethical AI and interpretability.

Contribution Guide

1. Create a branch for your change.
2. Keep modules and packages scoped; avoid cross-cutting edits unless necessary.
3. Add or update tests for behavior changes.
4. Run `npm run lint && npm test && npm run build` before opening a PR.
5. Keep documentation in sync with code changes.

Author and Acknowledgments

Author: Aarti Sri Ravikumar

Dedication: This project is dedicated by **Aarti S Ravikumar** to **Shishubharati**.

Institution and gratitude:

- Shishu Bharati School: https://www.shishubharati.net/
- Grateful acknowledgment to the teachers and volunteers for their service and inspiration.
- Intellectual inspiration from the Bhagavad Gita and the works of Swami Chinmayananda and Mahatma Gandhi.

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